supporting the people. I did the same for polio vaccination. When the military was fighting to secure polio workers (who were being attacked in droves), I wasn't supporting the army. I was supporting polio workers. Why shouldn't I? My origins are from amongst the people. The people of my country are my strength. They are my only interest. I will rise and fall with the people. That's why the Shahid Afridi Foundation is getting into everything – hospitals, water treatment plants, schools, even microfinance. Whatever I can do, I will do. Public service is the future for me.

I can't say what's next. I have a political bug, that's for sure. Yes, as clichéd as it sounds for many cricketers in South Asia, there is a political animal in me, but I will be the first to admit that I'm probably not cut out for contemporary local or national politics in Pakistan. Elders and mentors don't recommend it for me either. They are probably right.

Pakistani politics – or politics anywhere in the world – is a dirty business full of U-turns, lies, hypocrisy and insults. I don't think I'm looking forward to a future where I appear on some talk show and lie to millions just because that's the need of the job or the requirement of my political party. So, unless the nature of politics changes in Pakistan – a far shot, for I assume it's the same elsewhere too – I know I'm not naturally cut out to be a politician. If my elders advise otherwise, I may think about it.

As for social work, of course, I will never stop helping. The hospital I've made in Taghibanda, my birthplace in Khyber, will only grow. It used to be a 10-bed set-up but now we have expanded and have two more wards in there, including one labour room for mothers-to-be. I'm also planning to try out similar projects all over the country but focusing on underdeveloped areas at first. My approach is to first build small achievable projects without the hype. Not the huge national controversies that many 'celebrity projects' end up becoming. Even something as modest as a couple of rooms can function as a little medical clinic or a hospital as long as it's located in the right area and has the required facilities.

So, admittedly, I think I have these two bugs: politics and social work. But they both come from the same ambition: helping those who are in need. If it's politically possible, without the lies and the insulting, sure, I will do it politically. If I have to become a social worker, that's what I will do. But my ambition is to help others. It's how I always treated my teammates and it's how I want to treat the rest of my country.

I've been asked if I'd like to consider a future as a cricket coach. Honestly, I don't have the temperament for it. I may begin explaining something to a young lad and even attempt it a second time. But by the third attempt, if he doesn't get it, I'd probably end up slapping him. Okay, maybe I'm exaggerating (for the record, I've never struck a junior player) but I wasn't coddled or spoonfed my cricket – I don't know how to do it to another either. Modern coaching is about coddling. And coddling is for boys, not men.

So, coaching at the international level is out of the question. I know a lot of other guys in the team who have such ambitions – coaching a foreign team and living on the global circuit. Why, I wonder. Why not apply your great skills to help out local kids who need it the most at the U-14 level? Or coach the guys who are about to get a break and be 'discovered' at the U-19 level? Don't they need mentors? Don't they need an international star on their side to teach them how to excel and earn their spurs? That's the kind of mentoring and guidance that will make them international cricketers one day. That's the kind of cricketing ecosystem that will sustain Pakistan